

**CHAPTER 7****CULTURE****Learning Outcomes**

By the end of the chapter students will be able to:

1. Identify the different cultural groups living in Pakistan.
2. Identify the common characteristics of different cultures.
3. Describe the cultural diversity of Pakistan.
4. Identify the advantages of a multicultural society.
5. Compare (similarities and differences) the culture of Pakistan with that of another country.
6. Identify the main Institutions that socialize children into culture (religious Institutions, family, school etc).
7. List the ways families socialize their children into their culture.
8. Show through an example how culture changes to accommodate new ideas.

## CULTURE

### What is Culture?

Culture means the ways of living that a group of people have built up and passed on from one generation to another. Culture includes the way they dress, the food they eat, the language they speak, their customs and traditions (e.g. marriage and religious practices), the books they write, the music they play and listen to, the way they build their building and rules of behavior. Culture does not stay the same but changes with time and by interaction with other cultures.

#### Activity

Write a paragraph about your own culture including all the aspects mentioned above.

### The Cultural Diversity of Pakistan

There are many different groups of people living in Pakistan. Each group of people eats different foods, wears different clothes and speaks a different language. While each group of people is different, they also share many things in common. For example, all Pakistanis speak Urdu, eat *sabzi* and *roti* and wear the shalwar kameez. While most of the groups of people are Muslims, they belong to many different sects. In addition, there are groups of people who are Christian, Hindu, Sikh and Parsi living here. A society in which many groups of people from different cultural backgrounds live is a culturally diverse society or a multicultural society. In the next few paragraphs we will learn about the cultural diversity of Pakistan.

#### Activity

Name at least five different cultural groups living in Pakistan.

### Food

The food eaten daily in most Pakistani households is *roti* and *sabzi*. However, the *sabzi* changes depending upon what grows in each place and the *roti* is made from different ingredients and in different ways as well. In Sindh, *aaloo palak* and *chawal ki roti* is eaten. In the Punjab, *sarso ka saag* and *makai ki roti* is common. The Pakhtuns love to eat Sajji, Chapli Kabab and naan. The Balochis eat sajji, kaak (a rock hard bread) and in the coastal areas they eat fish prepared in a variety of way. Most people eat their food with their hands. Many also use spoons and forks to eat.



Sajji



Sabzi



Chawal ki Roti

### Dress

All the people of Pakistan wear the national dress which is the shalwar and kameez for men and shalwar, kameez and dupatta for women. However, the shalwar and kameez is made and embroidered differently in different parts of Pakistan. On special occasions men dress in a suit, Sherwani or add a waistcoat to the shalwar and kameez and women dress in gharara and saris. When going to work men wear suits, pants and shirts as well as the shalwar kameez. Working women generally dress in a simple shalwar and kameez.



The embroidery done on the Traditional Shalwar Kameez

### Activity

Identify the similarities and difference in the different cultural groups living in Pakistan.

### Languages

Language is the means by which we communicate with others. Urdu is the national language of Pakistan and is spoken by most Pakistanis. The majority of people in each province speak their provincial language, but there are other groups living there that speak other languages as well. For example, most people living in Sindh speak Sindhi, Siraiki, Gujrati and Kachhi are also spoken in Sindh. In the northern part of the Punjab most people speak Punjabi and in the southern part most people speak Saraiki. In Balochistan, Balochi, Brahvi and Pushto are spoken. In Khyber Pukhtunkhwa and FATA, Pushto, Hindko and Dari are spoken. In Gilgit-Baltistan, Shina, Brushasi, Khwar, Wakhi and Balti are spoken. English, the official language, is also spoken by many Pakistanis. It is taught in schools and is used in government and private offices. There are a lot of books written in all these languages as well.

### Religion and Religious Practices

According to the 1998 census, 96% of the people of Pakistan are Muslim. The remaining 4% of the people are Christians, Hindus, Buddhists, Sikhs and Parsis. As the majority of the people are Muslims, Islamic beliefs and practices influence the culture of the people. The Azan, the call to prayer is heard five times a day. During

culture of the people. The Azan, the call to prayer is heard five times a day. During the month of Ramzan, the month of fasting, restaurants are closed during the day in respect for those who are fasting. Muslims celebrate Eid-ul-Fitre, Eid-ul-Azah, and Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi. Other religious groups practice their religion. Christians go to church to pray and celebrate the feasts of Christmas and Easter. Hindus go to the temple to pray and celebrate Holi and Diwali.

The Urs of many sufi saints are celebrated all over Pakistan. The sufi saints promote peace, harmony and love of all. Therefore, people of all religions attend these celebrations.

### Festivals

There are a number of days that are important for all Pakistanis. These days are celebrated with great enthusiasm and fervor all over Pakistan. Independence Day is celebrated every year on 14<sup>th</sup> August and Pakistan Day on 23<sup>rd</sup> March.

In addition to festivals that are celebrated by the whole country, each province has festivals that are celebrated there. Basant is celebrated in the Punjab to herald the arrival of spring. In December of every year the people of Sindh celebrate Ekta Day or Sindh Unity Day. Sibi Mela is celebrated in Balochistan. Buzkashi is celebrated to show the bravery of the Pukhtuns in Khyber Pukhtunkhwa and the Shandur Polo festival is celebrated in Gilgit Baltistan.



Ekta Day



Kites of Basant



Sibi Mela



Buzkashi



Shandur Polo Festival

### Intellectual and artistic pursuits

Pakistanis are creative. They express their creativity in different forms of arts and crafts. Painting, calligraphy, music, drama, architecture and various kinds of handicrafts are created all over Pakistan. Many engage in these arts and crafts to earn a livelihood, while others do so to pass their leisure time.



Sindhi Women making a Rilli



Calligraphy



Artistic work on mini bus



Pottery made in Hala

**Activity:** List the Handicrafts produced in Sindh.

As we have learnt above a multicultural society is one in which different cultural Groups live. The degree to which groups respect each other determines whether a multicultural society is an advantage or not. When a society encourages the members of the different cultures to respect and be friends of each other, there is peace and harmony. Peace and harmony helps a society to grow and prosper. If there is selfishness and a lack of respect for differences in culture there is conflict among the different groups. The conflict can result in violence and even lead to war.

A multicultural society that encourages an exchange of culture enriches both individuals as well as communities. Individuals and communities learn to be respectful, become open-minded and learn new ways to deal with problems.

It is important that in a multicultural society, citizens learn to value diversity and difference as it helps to integrate the different groups into the larger society. When citizens feel part of their society, they are willing to make sacrifices for those with whom they live. This helps to make each 'I' into a common 'We' which is important

for development and progress of the society. It also helps to face any internal difficulty or external threat to the society.

**Activity:** List the possible advantages for individuals and the society from encouraging respect for others in a multicultural society.

## The Culture of Other Countries

In the next few pages you will learn about the culture of three other countries, China, Sri Lanka and United Kingdom.

### CHINA

China, our neighbour in the north is the world's most populous country, with a population of over 1.35 billion.



### Food

The most common food eaten in China is rice. People generally eat it steamed, fried or in the form of congee (Chinese rice porridge). Noodles are also eaten boiled or fried. Pork and chicken are the most popular meats in China. They make dumplings filled with the meat which is eaten steamed or fried. They eat their food with chopsticks. Chinese love their herbal teas which they drink all day long.



Chinese Noodles

### Dress

Chinese dress has changed greatly overtime. The Chinese Tunic Suit (Mao Suit) became common for both men and women from the founding of the People's Republic of China in 1949 till the 1980s. Cheongsam is the most popular attire for Chinese women. Nowadays, most Chinese wear modern clothes in their daily life with not much of a difference from people in the west. Traditional clothes are only worn during important festivals, ceremonies and religious occasions.



Chinese Tunic Suit and Cheongsam

### Languages

Many languages are spoken in China. Mandarin is the national language of China. There are many varieties of Mandarin spoken by the people. Other languages spoken are Wu, Cantonese and Southern Min.



Chinese Script

### Festivals

There are many festivals celebrated in China. Some of them are:

1. Chinese New Year (Spring Festival) is the most important traditional festival in China. The festival will falls on the first day of the first lunar month (between January 21 to February 21) and ends with the lantern festival which is on the fifteenth day. Days before the festival, Chinese people clean their houses to sweep away bad luck and bring good fortune in the New Year. Chinese travel from all over the country and abroad to be with their families. They celebrate the New Year with fireworks and dragon and lion dancing.
2. Lantern Festival. The lantern festival celebrated fifteen day after the New Year and is the first night of a full moon. During the lantern festival people celebrate the beginning of spring by watching lantern, fireworks and eating sweet stuffed dumplings in a soup.



Chinese celebrated New Year



Dragon Dancing on Chinese New Year

3. Laba Festival. This day is celebrated on eighth day of the twelfth month of the Chinese Lunar calendar. It is celebrated to mark the enlightenment day by Buddha. People usually eat Laba congee, which is made of mixed grains and fruits.



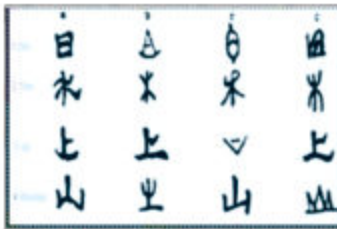
Laba congee being served at the Laba Festival

### Arts and Crafts

The Chinese are famous for their arts and crafts. The most common are Embroidery, Calligraphy, Music, Opera, Painting, Kite making, Lacquer Ware, Paper-Cuttings, Porcelain, Pottery and making of silk.



Porcelain ware



Chinese Calligraphy



Chinese Embroidery



Chinese Silk

### SRI LANKA

Sri Lanka is an island country in South Asia. It lies off the southern coast of India.



Sri Lanka's flag with map

### Food

Sri Lankans like to eat boiled or steamed rice with spicy curries. Side dishes include pickles, chutneys and sambols. The most famous of which is coconut sambol, made of ground coconut mixed with chilies, dried fish and lime juice. They also like to eat Hoppers which are made of rice flour, coconut milk and yeast. The better is cooked in a *karahi* like pan. There are many types of hoppers such as egg hoppers, milk hoppers and string hoppers. Tea is the drink of choice of most Sri Lankans.



Coconut Sambol



Egg Hopper

### Dress

The men in Sri Lanka generally wear a regular shirt and a sarong (a tube of fabric worn much like a *loongi*). They also wear pants and shirts and kurta pajama. The traditional dress of Sri Lankan women wear is the saree. Women also wear dresses, skirts and blouses and shalwar kameez.



Sarong and Sari worn by men and women in Sri Lanka

### Language

There are two large groups of people living in Sri Lanka: the Sinhalese and the Tamils. The Sinhalese speak Sinhala and the Tamils speak Tamil. Both of these are the official languages of Sri Lanka. English is also widely spoken here.

### Festivals

The Sinhala and Tamil New Year is a very important cultural festival. The festival is celebrated on April 14. It is family festival in which presence are exchanged, special food cooked and new clothes worn.

All Buddhist festivals are celebrated on the full moon or Poya Days. The most important Poya Day is the Vesak Poya on which is commemorated the birth enlightenment and death of Buddha. On this day lamps are lit in front of houses, pandals are decorated with scenes of life of Buddha and free food is distributed by the roadside. Devot Buddhist visit temples, meditate and fast.



### Arts and Crafts

One of the most notable aspects of Sri Lankan art and crafts are temple paintings. Traditional wooden handicrafts and clay pottery are common as is the Portuguese-inspired lacework and Indonesian-inspired Batik.



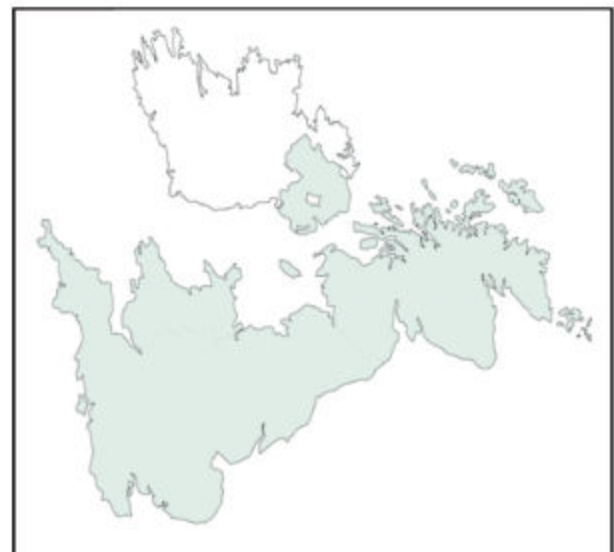
Sri Lankan's Batik

## THE UNITED KINGDOM

The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, commonly known as the UK or Britain is located off the north-western coast of the continent of Europe



United Kingdom Flag



United Kingdom Map

## Food

Traditional English foods include fish and chips, Yorkshire pudding and gravy and the Sunday roast (a joint of beef, lamb or chicken), served with boiled vegetables. The full English breakfast consists of bacon, grilled tomatoes, fried bread, black pudding, baked beans, fried mushrooms, sausages and eggs. Sweet dishes include scones, apple pie, mince pies and sponge cake. Scottish food includes Arbroath Smokie and Haggis; The Irish like to eat the Ulster fry and Irish Stew and the Welsh the Welsh rarebit. Tea is the most popular drink in the U.K.



## Dress

In England there is no specific national dress. Most men wear pants and shirts and most women dresses, skirts or trousers with blouses. In Scotland the national dress is the kilt which is like a skirt worn around the waist. In Wales the national costume is a long skirt worn with a petticoat and topped with a shawl.



## Languages

The English language is the language spoken by nearly the whole population of the UK. The people of Scotland speak Scottish, the people in Wales speak Welsh (Cymraeg) and the people living in Ireland speak Irish. People from all over the world have become citizens of the UK so many other languages are spoken here.

## Festivals

The Christian festivals of Christmas and Easter are national public holidays in the UK. Other festivals celebrated are the Edinburgh festival, St. Andrews Day, etc.



Edinburgh festival



St. Andrew's parade day



Christmas festival

### Arts and Crafts

Painting especially of portraits and landscapes is very famous. There are many institutions where people learn to paint and many galleries where the paintings are exhibited.



#### Activity

Find out about the culture of a country of your choice. Write about it and paste some pictures. Display the same in your class.

### Becoming a Part of a Cultural Group

When we are born we do not know how to speak a language, we do not have a liking for a particular food or dress. We learn how to live our lives by doing what we see others doing. The process of learning how to live life in cultural group is called socialization.

The first place where we learn how to live our lives is in our family. We hear a language spoken at home and soon speak that language (our mother tongue). We learn how to behave by seeing what others in our family do, such as, saying, 'salaam' to our elders when we meet them, saying our prayers at certain times of the day and eating all the food given to us. We wear the same kind of clothes as that of others in our family.

#### Activity

List three things that you have learnt from your family, that is different from what your friend has learnt from his/her family.

We also learn how to live our lives in other institutions such as schools and places of worship. Some of the behaviours and values we learn at home are useful at school. But schools also require us to behave in ways that differ from those of our homes. They require us to come to school on time, to come in neat and clean uniforms, to follow a timetable for classes and to work and play with others. Schools thus teach us the importance of time and cleanliness, of following a schedule and of teamwork.

Religion and religious institutions are an important means of socialization. We go to a particular place to worship. Here we learn a particular way to pray. We read a particular holy book and learn many important values from it. Many important events in our families such as birth, marriage and death have religious elements. We also celebrate many religious festivals. All the institutions of socialization, that is, our family, school and religious institutions teach us the way to live our lives. Thus, we can say that culture is transmitted through social institutions.

### **Cultural Change**

Culture does not stay the same. Every generation adds something to it from its experience which is then passed on to the next generation. As a result old cultural patterns are replaced by new ones. For example, not many Pakistanis in the past ate burgers and pizza or drank sweet fizzy drinks. Today, many people do. As a result many of them are becoming fat and suffering from illnesses such as diabetes and high blood pressure. Similarly, in the past families would spend their leisure time talking, telling stories or playing games together. Nowadays, most families spend their leisure time watching TV. They also go to parks or playgrounds to play games.

Today, the majority of people around the world speak English in addition to their mother tongue, they wear European style clothes, go to school to get an education and see themselves not only as being a part of their community, their country but also of the world. This is because travel and information communication technologies allow us to interact and learn from others.

### **SUMMARY**

In this chapter we have learnt that culture is the way of life built up and passed on from one generation to another, that although Pakistani share many things in common there is cultural diversity, and that a society that encourages members of the different cultures to respect each other live in peace and prosperity. We have also learnt about the culture of three other countries, China, Sri Lanka and the United Kingdom, the institutions through which we learn about our culture and that culture does not stay the same but changes over time.

## EXERCISE

### A. Multiple choice questions

1. For every question, three answers are given, tick the correct one.
  - i. What kind of society is Pakistan
    - a) Monocultural                      b) Bicultural                      c) Multicultural
  - ii. What is the first institution of socialization?
    - a) Family                                  b) School                                  c) Place of worship
  - iii. What is the language spoken by the largest number of people in the world?
    - a) English                                  b) Mandarin                                  c) Spanish
  - iv. The two largest cultural groups living in Sri Lanka are
    - a) Sinhalese and Tamils    b) Sinhalese and Burbers    c) Tamils and Burbers
  - V. Which is the most populous country of the world?
    - a) China                                      b) Great Britian                                  c) India

### B. Answer the following questions

1. Define the word 'culture'.
2. There are many groups of people living in Pakistan; they share many things in common. List the things all the groups share. What are the advantages of having a common culture.
3. List the advantages and challenges of a multicultural society.
4. Compare the culture of Pakistan with the culture of one of the three countries given in this chapter.
5. List the ways in which a child becomes a part of a cultural group.

### C. Make a table

Make a table like the one below to show the cultural similarities and differences between yourself and a friend.

| Cultural characteristics that only my friend has | Cultural characteristics that we have in common | Cultural characteristics that only I have |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
|                                                  |                                                 |                                           |

### D. Practical work

1. Interview your parents to find out about their way of life (keep cultural characteristics in mind). Then reflect and write about your way of life. Compare the change and identify what caused the changes.
2. Find out how technology is changing the way we live our lives
  - a. Find out and list all the technological devices your parents used.
  - b. Identify all of the technological devices that are used today on a daily basis.
  - c. Identify how this technology has altered what we do, how we behave and our relationships with others.
  - d. What changes has technology brought?
  - e. What further changes might you predict?

### E. Extension activity

Find out about the culture of a country of your choice. Then make and fill in a table like the one given below.

| Cultural Characteristics | Pakistan | Country _____ |
|--------------------------|----------|---------------|
| Dress                    |          |               |